DATA SAFETY BASICS

Sync is a mirror. Backup is a safety net.

They sound alike, but they answer different questions. Mixing them up is how people lose their photos.

SYNC

Keeps your devices matching



Whatever changes on one side changes on the other, **including deletions, edits and corruption.**

Examples: iCloud Photos, Google Photos, Dropbox, OneDrive

BACKUP

Keeps a separate copy of the past



A copy that **doesn't change when the original does**, with older versions kept so you can go back in time.

Examples: external drive, encrypted off-site storage, a second provider

What happens when...

SCENARIO	SYNC ONLY	WITH BACKUP
You delete a photo by mistake	Gone everywhere (short trash window)	Still in the archive
Your account is locked or hacked	Everything goes with it	Safe, held under a different account
Ransomware or corruption spreads	Bad files sync to the cloud	Earlier clean versions remain
Phone is lost or stolen	Safe, if the account stays secure	Safe

3-2-1

3 copies of your data, on **2** kinds of storage, with **1** kept off-site. Then **test a restore**. A backup you've never restored is a hope, not a backup.